GRANDMA PROOF - ILLUSTRATED HANDOUT

VoiceMeeter Potato for Windows

Sound, sorted - one click at a time.

Every step gets its own page. Every page gets a picture.
Do not rush. Tick the green box before you turn the page.



LOOK: This is VoiceMeeter Potato. Yours will look like this. The names on yours may be a little different - that is normal.

You need: a Windows computer, headphones or speakers, a microphone, and about 20 minutes. Nothing else.

How to use this handout: One page = one job. Find the red circle in the picture. Click that spot on your computer. Then tick the green CHECK box. **New in this version:** when a step names a button, the picture now IS that button - cut out of the real screen, so it looks exactly like yours. **Part 2 - Know Your Mixer** (pages 13-27) then walks you round every part of the Potato screen.

Official download: vb-audio.com - VoiceMeeter Potato page. Version in this handout: Voicemeeter 3.1.3.0 (ZIP package, 72.2 MB). Potato is donationware from VB-Audio Software.

BEFORE YOU CLICK ANYTHING

The one idea: a traffic controller for sound

Sound comes **IN** on the left. You press a button to say where it goes **OUT**. That is the whole program.

A

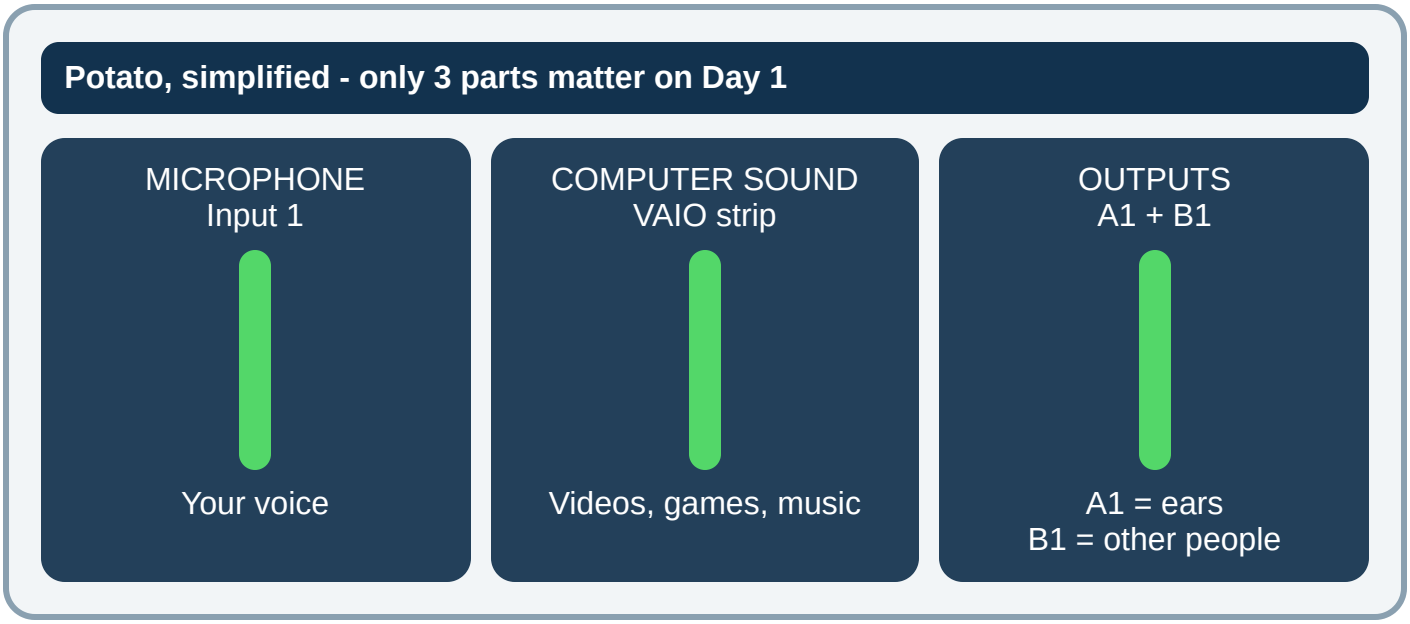
A = Actual ears

Sound for YOU.
Goes to your real headphones or speakers.

B

B = Broadcast

Sound for OTHER PEOPLE.
Discord, Zoom and OBS hear this.



Potato has 5 real inputs, 5 real outputs (A1-A5) and 3 pretend - virtual - ones (B1-B3). **Ignore the rest for now.** Beginners only need **Input 1, A1 and B1**.

CHECK: You can say it out loud - "A is for my ears. B is for other people." Then turn the page.

1

Download it - from the ONLY safe place

Go to **vb-audio.com** and open the **VoiceMeeter Potato** page.

vb-audio.com > VoiceMeeter Potato

1 **Click this ZIP file:**

Voicemeeter8Setup_v3130.zip
Voicemeeter 3.1.3.0 - 72.2 MB

That one file installs Potato. It also installs the smaller Banana and standard versions - you only open Potato.

STOP - never download it from anywhere else. Not FileHippo, not a random "free download" site. Only vb-audio.com.

CHECK: Look in your **Downloads** folder. Is the ZIP file there, about 72 MB? Tick this box and turn the page.

2

Install it - then RESTART

Three clicks to install. Then the most important click of all: Restart.

In your Downloads folder

1. Right-click the ZIP

Extract All

2. In the new folder, right-click the Setup program

Run as administrator

3. ! Click

INSTALL

DO NOT SKIP THE RESTART. When install finishes, restart the whole computer. VB-Audio says: run Setup as administrator and reboot after installation. Without the restart, the new sound devices do not appear - and Steps 5 and 6 cannot work.

CHECK: Your computer has restarted. Now turn the page - we prove it worked in Steps 5 and 6.

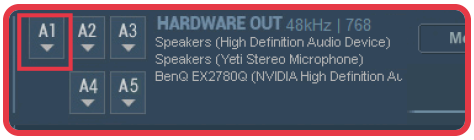
3

Tell Potato where your ears are: A1

Open **VoiceMeeter Potato** from the Start menu. Look at the **top-right corner**.



LOOK: Top-right says HARDWARE OUT. A1, A2, A3 sit above A4 and A5. Click A1.



REAL BUTTONS - cut out of the real Potato screen above. Click **A1**, inside the red box.

Click A1



This is A1, big.

Then pick your **headphones or speakers** from the list that drops down under A1.

If you see two versions of the same name, pick the one that starts with **WDM** - or **ASIO**, if you see it and you use a proper audio interface.

Set A1 FIRST, before anything else. Until A1 is set, you will hear nothing at all. This is the number 1 beginner panic - and now you know why.

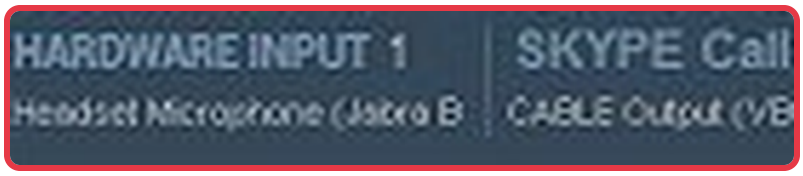
Do this once - so Potato starts by itself: click **Menu** (top-right corner) and turn ON **Run at Startup**. Now Potato is already open after every restart. If Potato is not open, there is no sound at all.

CHECK: The A1 button now shows the name of your headphones or speakers next to it.

4

Tell Potato where your voice is

Now the **top-left corner**. Click **Hardware Input 1** and pick your microphone.



REAL BUTTON AREA - the top of the first strip, cut out of the real screen. Click the name **HARDWARE INPUT 1**.

Pick **your microphone** from the list.

Two versions again?
Pick **WDM**.

Talk test

Green and yellow bars dance when you talk

Your microphone strip is the tall strip on the far left. When you talk, the coloured bars next to it should move up and down - engineers call that "dancing."

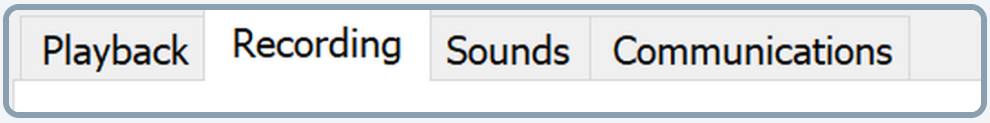
CHECK: Talk in a normal voice. Do the bars dance? Yes - turn the page. No - click Input 1 again and pick a different microphone from the list.

5

Make Potato the boss of ALL Windows sound - Part 1

Press the **Windows key + R** together. Type **mmsys.cpl** and press **Enter**. One old-style Sound box opens.

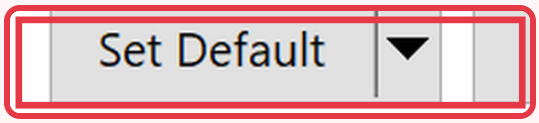
Sound box - Playback part



REAL TABS - cut out of the real Sound box. You are on **Playback** for this part.

Speakers
Realtek - your old default

1 **Voicemeeter Input**
VB-Audio Voicemeeter VAIO



Click this exact button below the list - the real one, cut out of the Sound box.

If a **Set Default Communication Device** choice appears, choose it for this same device too.

Why it looks backwards: Playback "Input" means sound goes **IN to Potato**. Backwards name, correct setting.

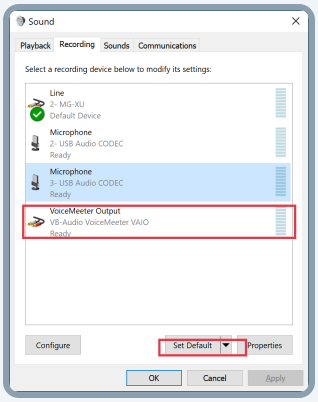
CHECK: A green tick now sits on **Voicemeeter Input (VB-Audio Voicemeeter VAIO)**. Stay in this same box - Part 2 is next.

5

Make Potato the boss - Part 2: Recording

Still in that same Sound box? Click the **Recording** tab at the top.

Sound box - Recording part (a real one)

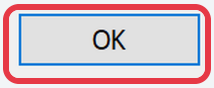


THE REAL SOUND BOX. Click the **VoiceMeeter Output** row (top red box), then **Set Default** (bottom red box). The other names came from the computer that took this picture - yours will be a little different, and that is fine.

Can't see Voicemeeter Output? Look for **Voicemeeter Out B1** - same thing, newer name.

One quick extra job before you close: click the **Communications** tab at the top of this same box and choose **Do nothing**. That stops Windows turning all your sound down in the middle of a Discord or Zoom call.

Now click this real **OK** button to close the box:



Backwards again - and still correct: Recording "Output" means sound comes **OUT of Potato** to your apps, so Discord and Zoom can hear you.

CHECK - the big test: Play any YouTube video. You can **hear it**, and the middle strip in Potato dances. Both? Windows is now Potato's. Turn the page.

6

The golden routing - set these buttons

Back in Potato. Every strip has small **A** and **B** buttons on its right side. Lit = ON. Dark = OFF. Set just these:

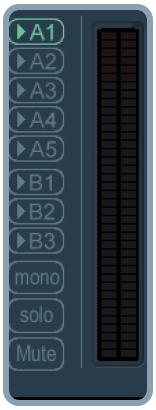
The only 2 strips you touch today - real buttons

YOUR MICROPHONE
Input 1



B1 is GREEN = ON
A1 is grey = OFF

COMPUTER SOUND
VAIO strip



A1 is GREEN = ON
B1 is grey = OFF*

* Turn computer B1 ON only when people on a call should also hear your videos or game. These are the real buttons, cut out of the screen - green means ON, grey means OFF.

Why mic A1 is OFF: A1 is your own ears. Mic to A1 means hearing your own voice back in your headphones. Nobody wants that. Mic to **B1** sends your voice to other people instead.

CHECK: Play a video - you hear it. Talk - the mic bars dance, but your voice is NOT in your headphones. Perfect. You are set up.

Way 1: Everything together

Use this on Day 1. It is what you already did in Step 5 - and for many people, it is enough forever.



Good for	Remember
Beginners, everyday listening, first calls	Windows default stays on Voicemeeter Input / Output - do not change it back

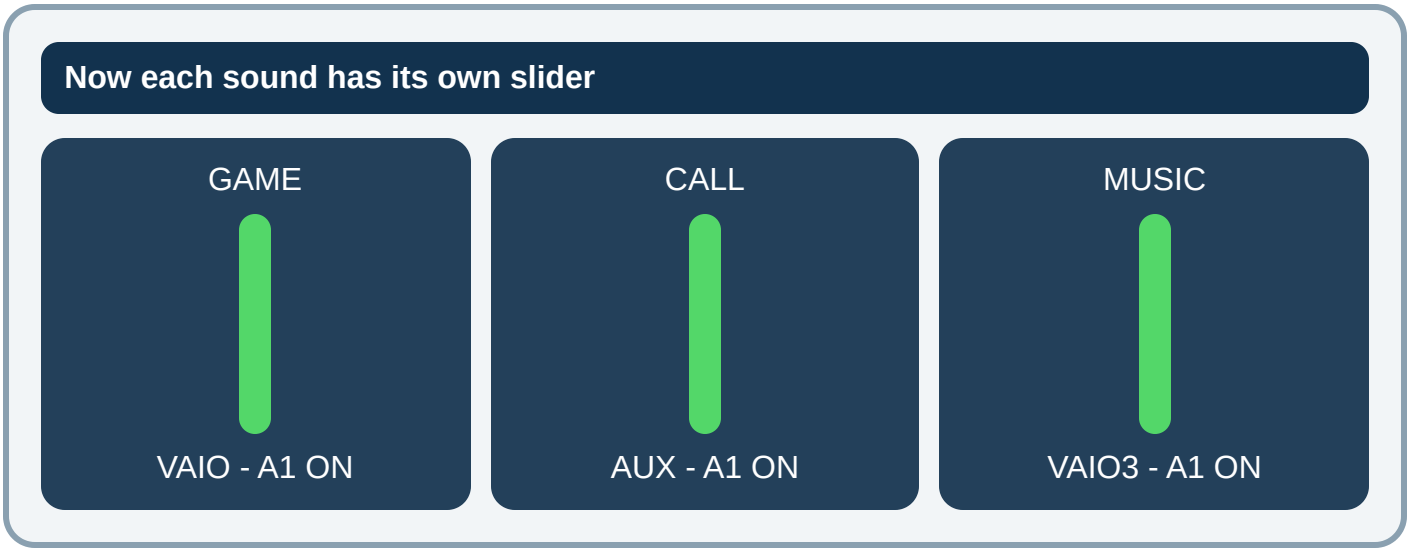
CHECK: Drag the VAIO strip slider in Potato. ALL computer sound gets quieter and louder together. That is Way 1 working.

Way 2: Split your apps in Windows

Use this in Week 2, when you want the game loud and Discord quiet - each on its own slider.

Open **Settings > System > Sound > Volume mixer**. Next to each app, choose where it sends its sound:

App	Send it to	Its strip in Potato
Game	Voicemeeter Input (VAIO)	VAIO strip
Discord / Zoom	Voicemeeter Aux Input	AUX strip
Music / Browser	Voicemeeter VAIO3 Input	VAIO3 strip



CHECK: Play music and a game at the same time. Move ONE strip slider. Only that one sound changes. That is Way 2 working.

Way 3: Set it inside the app itself

Use this for calls and recording. Leave Windows alone. Open the settings *inside* Discord, Zoom or OBS and set these two lines:

Inside Discord / Zoom / OBS - Audio settings

1. **Microphone / Input device**

   Voicemeeter Output (VB-Audio Voicemeeter VAIO)
   This is B1 - your voice, already mixed by Potato

2. **Speaker / Output device**

   Voicemeeter Aux Input (VB-Audio Voicemeeter AUX VAIO)
   Call sound lands on its own AUX strip, separate from your game

This keeps call sound on the AUX strip, so you can turn the call up or down without touching game or music volume.

Can't see Voicemeeter Output? Look for **Voicemeeter Out B1** - same thing, newer name.

CHECK: Join a test call. The other person hears you, you hear them, and their voice moves the AUX strip - not the VAIO strip.

PART 2 - KNOW YOUR MIXER

Know Your Mixer: the map

Potato is set up. Now learn what every part of the screen does. We go round the screen in **7 sections**, in the same order every time.



LOOK: the whole Potato window, split into 7 sections. Find each number on your own screen. (Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.)

1. **Top bar** - Menu, VBAN, window buttons
2. **Hardware inputs 1-5** - mics and instruments
3. **Virtual inputs** - computer sound: VAIO, AUX, VAIO3
4. **Hardware Out A1-A5** - your headphones and speakers
5. **Cassette recorder** - record and play back
6. **Special FX** - Reverb, Delay, External FX Return
7. **Master section** - all 8 outputs: A1-A5 real, B1-B3 virtual

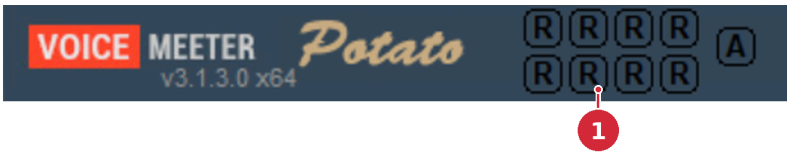
Every section has 2 pages. Page 1: the picture with red numbers, and a table saying what each number does. Page 2: real examples, a **Try it now**, a STOP box and a CHECK box.

Pictures in Part 2 are **real screenshots** of a fresh Voicemeeter Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10 (100% display size), enlarged, with red numbers added - nothing picked yet, so yours may show your own device names. Four things that only open on a click are labelled VB-Audio manual figures: the Menu, the A1 device list, Recorder Options, the Reverb panel.

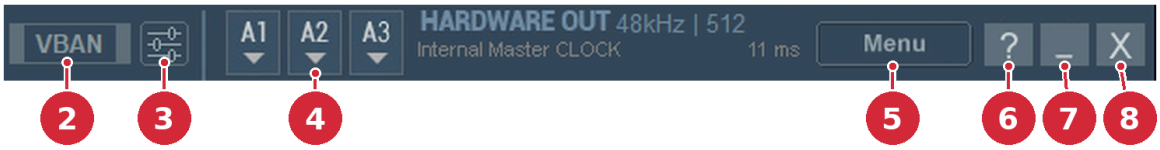
CHECK: Open Potato. Point at all 7 sections on your own screen, in order.

1 The top bar

The strip along the very top. Left end: the Potato name. Right end: VBAN, Menu and the window buttons.



Left end. Your version is under the logo: **v3.1.3.0 x64**. (Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.)



Right end. (Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.)

#	Control	What it does
1	Small R and A boxes	The manual does not explain these. Leave them alone.
2	**VBAN**	Opens the VBAN settings box. VBAN sends sound to - or gets sound from - other computers on your home or office network.
3	Small icon next to VBAN	Not explained in the manual. Leave it alone.
4	A1 A2 A3 (A4 A5 below) + HARDWARE OUT	Where you pick your headphones and speakers. That is Section 4.
5	**Menu**	Potato's main menu: Restart Audio Engine, Load / Save Settings, System Tray, Run on Windows Startup, Lock Graphic User Interface, System Settings and more.
6	**?**	Not explained in the manual.
7	_	Hides the window - the usual Windows minimise button. Potato keeps running.
8	**X**	The usual Windows close button. Closing Potato can stop ALL sound - see the STOP box over the page.

Macro buttons are not on this window: MacroButtons is a separate VB-Audio app, started from the Menu ("Run MacroButtons on Voicemeeter start").

The top bar in real life

Zoom / Teams training

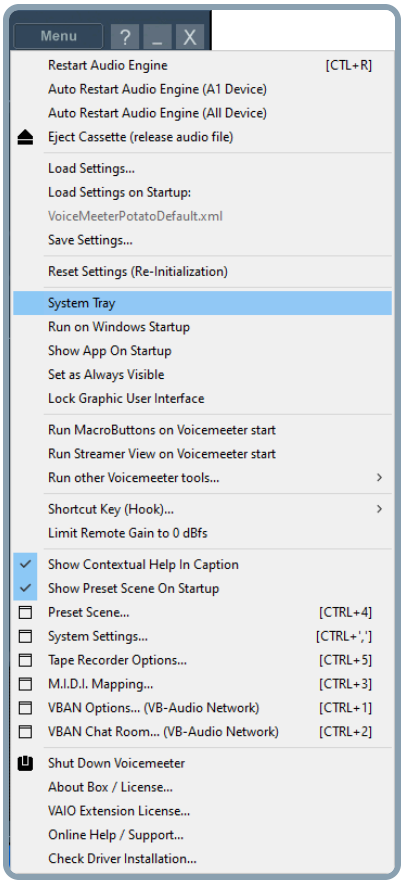
Got the room sounding right? Click **Menu > Save Settings...** and save a file. Next session, **Menu > Load Settings...** brings it all back.

Discord gaming

Plugged in a USB headset and the sound stopped? Click **Menu > Restart Audio Engine**. VB-Audio says this restarts the sound when a device was plugged or unplugged.

OBS stream

Going live? **Menu > Lock Graphic User Interface** stops a stray click changing your settings mid-stream.



The Menu, opened (official manual figure, p.47).

Try it now: Click **Menu**. Find **Restart Audio Engine** and click it - that is the fix you will use most. Open Menu again and check **Run on Windows Startup** has a tick (Step 3 calls it "Run at Startup").

STOP - do not click X to "tidy up". If Potato is closed while Windows still uses it, there is no sound at all. Click _ instead to hide it.
Never click Reset Settings in the Menu unless your trainer says so - it wipes your whole setup.

CHECK: You can find **Menu**, and **Restart Audio Engine** inside it, without looking at this page.

2 Hardware inputs 1-5

Five strips on the left - one per mic or instrument. All five work the same: learn one.



Strip 1, "Stereo Input 1". Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.

#	Control	What it does
1	Name + device	Shows **Stereo Input 1** / **Select Input Device**. Click to pick your mic.
2	INTELLIPAN	Drag the dot to change the "colour" of your voice.
3	EQ	Right-click: opens a 6-band EQ for this strip.
4	Comp	Compressor: evens out loud and quiet - and boosts the voice.
5	Gate	Closes (silences) when sound drops below a level.
6	Denoiser	Removes background noise, 0 to 10. Adds a little delay when not 0.
7	Reverb send	How much of this strip goes into the Reverb (Section 6).
8	Delay send	Into the Delay. Says **C5** instead if C5 was swapped in for the Delay.
9	Post	Lit = the send follows the fader.
10	External FX 1 / 2	Only works with an ASIO device on A1. Leave at 0.
11	Meter	How loud the sound coming in is. Click in it to set a limit.
12	Fader Gain	Volume of this strip.
13	A1-A5	Send to real outputs - your ears. Lit = ON.
14	B1-B3	Send to virtual outputs - what Discord, Zoom, OBS hear.
15	mono	Makes this strip mono (the manual gives no more detail).
16	solo	Listen to only this strip (or a few).
17	Mute	Silences this strip.

Hardware inputs in real life

Zoom / Teams training call

Mic on Input 1: **B1 ON, A1 OFF** (Step 6). Computer fan humming? Turn **Denoiser (6)** up a little at a time until the hum goes.

Podcast recording

Host mic on Input 1, guest mic on Input 2, both **B1 ON**. Turn **Comp (4)** up a little so voices stay steady. Comp boosts the voice, so pull the **fader (12)** down to match.

Discord gaming

Stepping away? Click **Mute (17)** on your mic strip. Want to hear only your mic for a test? Click **solo (16)**, then click it again to finish.

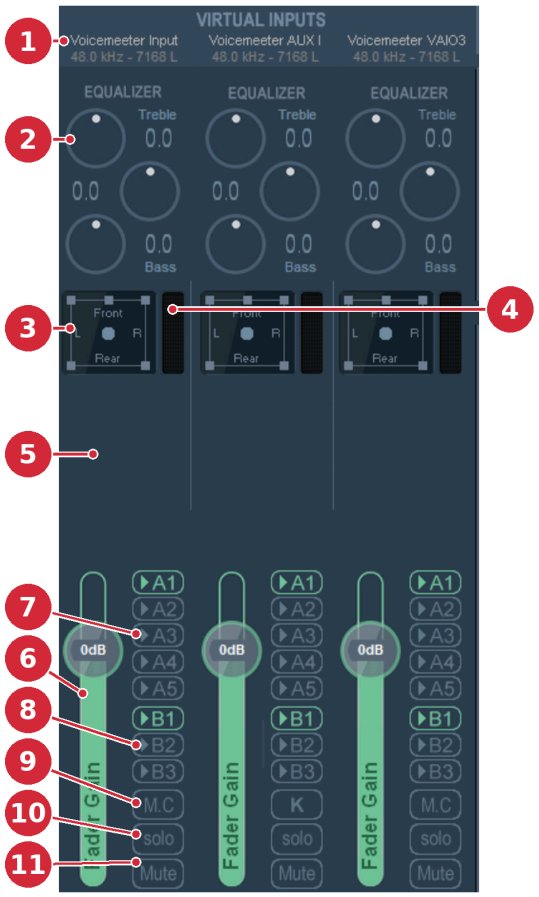
Try it now: Talk - watch the **meter (11)** move. Turn **Denoiser (6)** to 5, then back to 0. Click **Mute (17)**: it lights up. Click it again to turn it off.

STOP - hearing your own voice in your headphones? Mic **A1** is ON. Turn it OFF; keep **B1** ON.
A strange panel took over the strip? You right-clicked a knob. Right-click it again to go back.
Knob moved by accident? Double-click it - it goes back to its default.

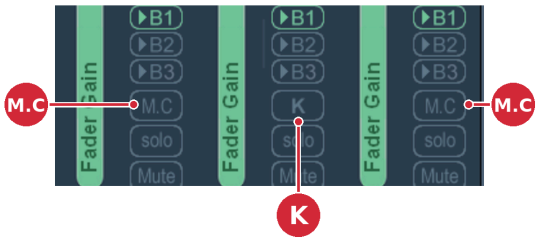
CHECK: Say out loud what **A1**, **B1** and **Mute** do on your mic strip, and point at **Denoiser**.

3 Virtual inputs: computer sound

Three strips in the middle. Sound from Windows and your apps comes in here - no cable needed.



Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.



AUX has **K**; the other two have **M.C**. (Real screenshot.)

#	Control	What it does
1	Strip name	**Voicemeeter Input** (VAIO), **Voicemeeter AUX I**nput (AUX), **Voicemeeter VAIO3**. Below it, **48.0 kHz - 7168 L**: the sample rate, and the strip's delay (latency) setting - 7168 is the safe default. Leave it.
2	EQUALIZER	3 knobs: Treble (top), Bass (bottom), medium (middle). Boost or cut.
3	5.1 pan	Drag the dot to place the sound front / back, left / right. Double-click to centre.
4	Meter	How loud this strip is.
5	App list	Empty here - nothing is playing yet. Apps playing into this strip, each with a slider and **M** (mute) - the same as the Windows Volume mixer. Right-click to show more.
6	Fader Gain	Volume of ALL sound on this strip.
7	A1-A5	To real outputs - your ears.
8	B1-B3	To virtual outputs - calls and streams.
9	M.C	"Mute Center": mutes the centre channel - where film dialogue sits - on 5.1 / 7.1 sound.
10	solo	Listen to only this strip.
11	Mute	Silences this strip.
K	K (AUX)	Karaoke: removes the voice from music. 4 modes: K-m, K-1, K-2, Kv.

Virtual inputs in real life

Discord gaming

Game to **VAIO**, Discord to **AUX** (Way 2 or Way 3). Friends too loud? Pull the **AUX fader (6)** down - the game stays the same.

OBS stream

Music player to **VAIO 3**. Turn **A1** ON so you hear it and **B1** ON so the stream hears it. Too loud for viewers? Lower the VAIO 3 fader.

Zoom / Teams training

Showing a video to the class? Turn **B1 ON** on the VAIO strip so the call hears the video too. Turn it OFF again afterwards.

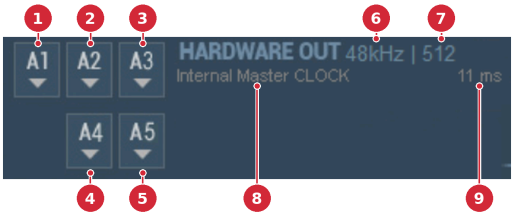
Try it now: Play a YouTube video. Find your browser in the **app list (5)**. Move its small slider - then open the Windows Volume mixer: the browser's slider moved there too.

STOP - an app is missing from the list, or a closed app is still there? Click **Menu > Restart Audio Engine** - it refreshes the list.
Discord shows up on every strip? That is Discord opening every device, not your mistake.
Voices vanished from your music? K is ON. Click it OFF.

CHECK: You can say which strip your browser plays into, and turn just that strip down.

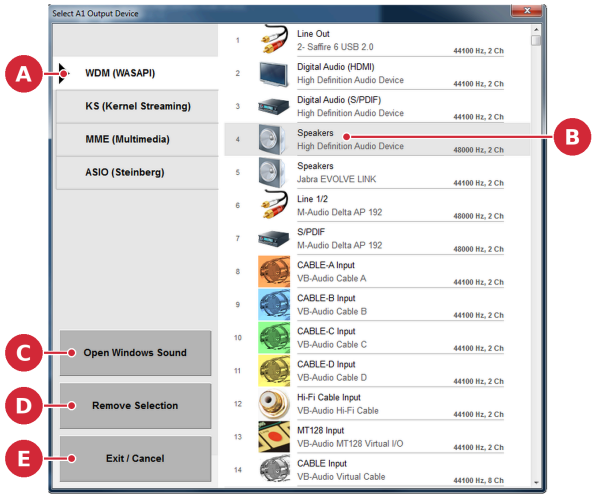
4 Hardware Out A1-A5

Top right. Five buttons - one for each pair of headphones or speakers you can use.



Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10 - nothing picked on A1 yet.

#	Control	What it does
1	**A1**	Click to pick your main headphones or speakers. A1 is the boss: it sets the clock and sample rate for the whole mixer. Set it first.
2 to 5	A2, A3, A4, A5	Extra real outputs: a second headset, room speakers and so on.
6	48kHz	The sample rate the whole mixer runs at. A1 sets it.
7	512	Not labelled in the manual. Most likely the buffer size: 512 samples is the WDM default. Leave it.
8	Internal Master CLOCK	Nothing on A1 yet: Potato runs on its own clock. Pick A1 and it sets the clock.
9	11 ms	Not explained in the manual. Leave it.



What opens when you click A1 (official manual figure, p.14).

A	WDM / KS / MME / ASIO	Driver type. Pick **ASIO** (if you have one) or **WDM**. MME only if WDM does not work.
B	Device list	Click your headphones or speakers.
C to E	Buttons	**Open Windows Sound** opens the Windows Sound box. **Remove Selection** un-picks the device. **Exit / Cancel** closes the list.

Hardware Out in real life

Zoom / Teams training room

A1 = trainer's headset. **A2** = the room speakers. Turn **A2** ON only on the strips the room should hear - a training video, say.

Podcast recording

A1 = host's headphones, **A2** = guest's headphones. Host mic strip: **A2** ON, so the guest hears you. Guest mic strip: **A1** ON, so you hear the guest. Nobody hears their own voice back.

Discord gaming

A1 = your headset, **A2** = desk speakers. Game strip: A1 and A2 ON. Discord (AUX) strip: A1 only - the room hears the game, not your friends.

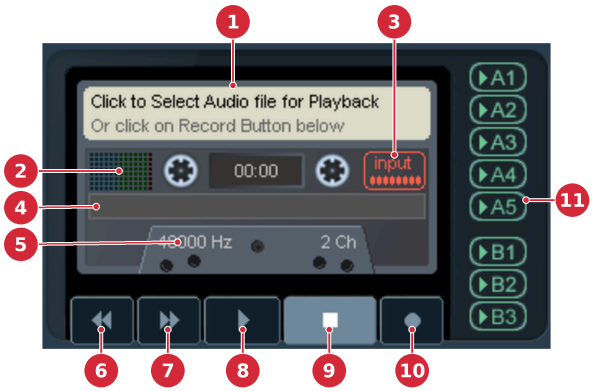
Try it now: Click **A2**. Look at the list and the WDM / KS / MME / ASIO tabs. Do not pick anything - click **Exit / Cancel**.

STOP - another app can't play to your headphones? Potato is holding them: WDM and KS devices are used "exclusive" by default. Send that app's sound through Potato instead.
A small echo when A1 and A2 both play? VB-Audio says outputs are not exactly in sync - that is normal. It can be fixed with a delay in System Settings.

CHECK: You can say what is on your A1 - and you know A1 must be set before anything else works.

5 The cassette recorder

The little tape deck, top right. It plays sound files and records what Potato hears.



Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.

#	Control	What it does
1	Cassette top	Click it to choose a file to play. Then it shows the file name and folder.
2	Input level	How loud the sound going to the recorder is.
3	Armed source	What will be recorded - **input** here.
4	Progress bar	Click it to jump to a spot in the file.
5	Sound format	Rate and channels: 48000 Hz, 2 Ch.
6 to 9	REW, FF, Play, Stop	Like a real tape player.
10	Record / Pause	Records to a new file in **Documents > Voicemeeter**, named with the date and time.
11	A1-B3	Where the played file goes - your ears (A), a call (B).

Right-click the tape deck for the Recorder Options:



Official manual figure (p.45) - this box only opens on right-click.

A record inputs (before faders and effects) - **B** or record ONE bus: exactly what you hear on it - **C** folder - **D** file type: WAV, BWF, AIFF or MP3 (MP3 = stereo only) - **E** keep the seconds before you pressed Record - **F** play on load / loop - **G** playback volume - **H** stop recording after a set time.

The recorder in real life

Podcast recording

Right-click the tape deck. Choose **Post-fader outputs (B)** and the bus both mics go to - **BUS B1**. Close the box, press **Record (10)**. Press **Stop (9)** at the end.

Zoom / Teams training

Record the session for people who missed it: record **BUS B1** the same way. Set **H** (stop after) to the length of the session, so it stops by itself.

OBS stream / Discord

Play an intro jingle: click the **cassette top (1)**, pick the file, turn **A1** (you) and **B1** (stream or call) ON at **11**, press **Play (8)**.

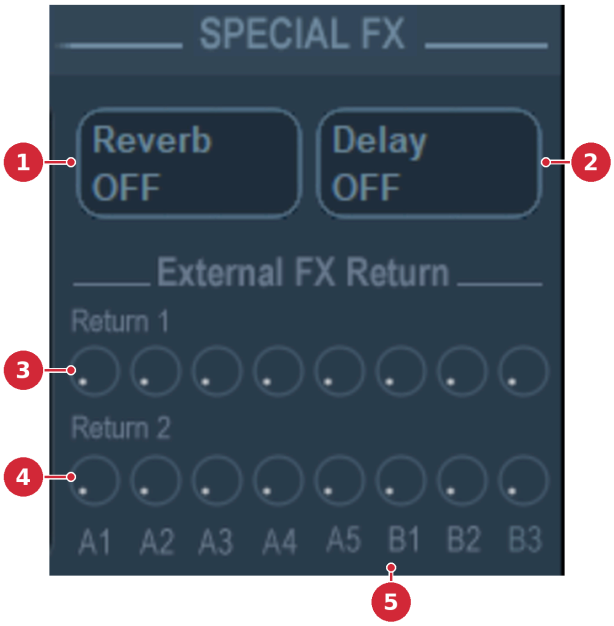
Try it now: Press **Record (10)**, say "testing, one, two", press **Stop (9)**. Open **Documents > Voicemeeter** - your file is there. Click the cassette top and play it back.

STOP - the recording is silent or wrong? Look at **3**: that is what is being recorded. Right-click the tape deck and pick the right inputs or bus.
A file is stuck and won't let go? Menu > Eject Cassette (release audio file).

CHECK: You made a test recording, found it in Documents > Voicemeeter, and played it back.

6 Special FX: Reverb and Delay

Top right corner. Potato's own echo effects - plus the returns for outside effects.

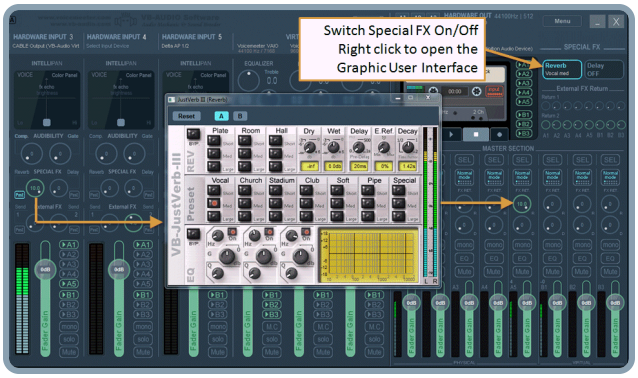


Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.

#	Control	What it does
1	**Reverb**	Turns the reverb ("room sound") ON / OFF - it says **OFF** here. Right-click opens its panel.
2	**Delay**	Same for the Delay (repeating echo). Can be swapped for the C5 compressor in System Settings.
3	Return 1	How much of outside effect 1 comes back into each bus.
4	Return 2	The same for outside effect 2.
5	A1 ... B3	Which bus each Return knob feeds.

How effects work - send and return: an effect needs **three** things.
1. The effect button ON (here). 2. A **send** knob turned up on the mic strip (Section 2, numbers 7 and 8). 3. A **return** knob turned up on the output bus (Section 7, numbers 3 and 4).

External FX (3 and 4) only work with an ASIO device on A1, with its channels set in System Settings. Beginners: leave them at 0.



Right-click Reverb to open its panel (official manual figure, p.39). Orange arrows: from a strip's send, to a bus's return.

Special FX in real life

Podcast recording

A touch of "room" on the host's voice: **Reverb ON (1)**, host strip **Reverb send** up a little, **B1 reverb return** up. A little goes a long way.

OBS stream

A big echo for a "hype" moment: **Delay ON (2)**, mic **Delay send** up, stream bus **Delay return** up. Turn the send back to 0 afterwards.

Zoom / Teams training

Keep Reverb and Delay **OFF**. A clear, dry voice is easiest to understand on a call.

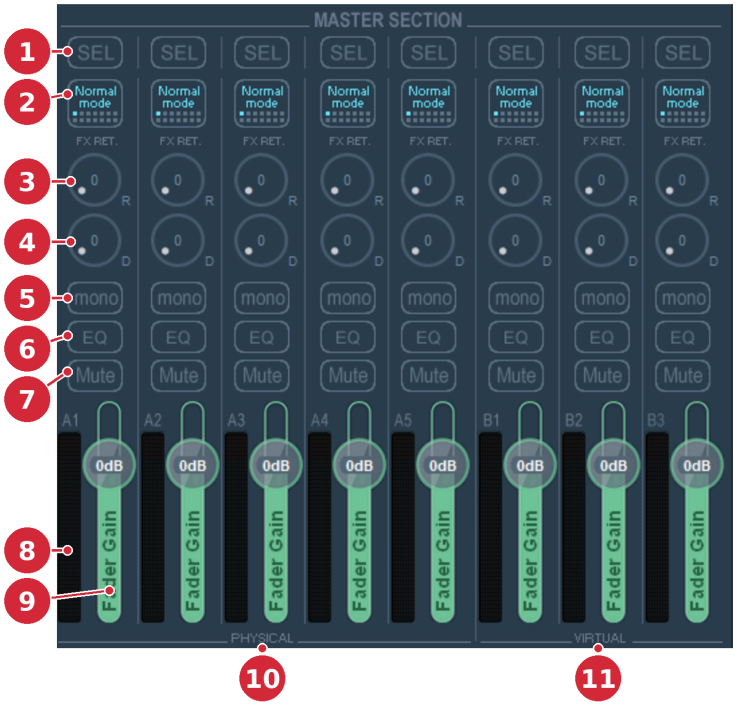
Try it now: Click **Reverb (1)** ON. Turn the mic strip's Reverb send up. Turn **A1**'s reverb return up (Section 7, number 3). Talk - you hear the reverb in your headphones. Now set both knobs back to 0.

STOP - effect does nothing? Check all three: button ON, send up, return up. **External FX does nothing?** Normal - it needs an ASIO device on A1. Leave it at 0.

CHECK: You can say the three things an effect needs: button, send, return.

7 The Master section: all 8 outputs

Bottom right. One column per output bus: **A1-A5** go to real devices, **B1-B3** to virtual ones. All 8 columns work the same.



Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.

#	Control	What it does
1	SEL	Select this bus's own mix: the input faders now show and set levels for this bus only.
2	Bus mode	How the bus's 8 channels are arranged. Keep **Normal mode**.
3	FX RET. R	Reverb return into this bus.
4	FX RET. D	Delay return (shows C when C5 is in use).
5	mono	Stereo to mono. Click twice: swaps left and right.
6	EQ	This bus's 6-band EQ ON / OFF. Right-click to open it.
7	Mute	Mutes this whole output.
8	Meter	How loud this output is. Its name sits on top.
9	Fader Gain	Volume of this whole output.

10	**PHYSICAL** A1-A5	Go to real headphones and speakers (Section 4).
11	**VIRTUAL** B1-B3	Appear in Windows as recording devices: B1 = **Voicemeeter Output**, B2 = **Voicemeeter Aux Output**, B3 = **Voicemeeter VAIO3 Output**. Newer names: **Voicemeeter Out B1 / B2 / B3**.

The Master section in real life

Zoom / Teams training

Need a private word? Click **Mute (7)** on **B1** - the call hears nothing from you. Click again to come back. Everything is too loud in your headset? Lower the **A1 fader (9)**.

OBS stream + Discord together

Discord's mic = **Voicemeeter Output** (B1). OBS's audio = **Voicemeeter Aux Output** (B2). Now the stream and your friends can get different mixes - use **SEL (1)** to set each one.

Podcast recording

Record **BUS B1** with the cassette (Section 5) and watch the **B1 meter (8)** move while you both talk. Still? Nothing is reaching B1 - check B1 is ON on both mic strips.

Try it now: Play a video. Drag the **A1 fader (9)** down, then back up. Click **A1 Mute (7)** - silence. Click it again - sound is back.

STOP - all the input faders suddenly show strange numbers? You clicked a **SEL** button: the faders now show that bus's own mix. Click the lit SEL again to go back.
Bus mode no longer says "Normal mode"? Ask your trainer - the manual does not say how to change it back.

CHECK: You can point at A1 and B1 in the Master section, and say which one is your ears and which one is the call.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

No sound? Check in THIS order

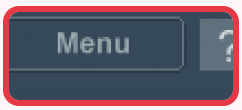
Do not jump around. Start at 1. Most problems die at 1, 2 or 3.

1 Is Potato actually open?
No Potato open = no sound at all. Open it from the Start menu and leave it open.

2 Is A1 picked, top-right?
A1 must show your headphones or speakers (Step 3).

3 Is A1 lit up on the strip that is playing?
Dark A1 button = that sound goes nowhere you can hear (Step 6).

4 Still stuck? Restart the engine, not the computer
In Potato, click this real **Menu** button in the top-right corner:



Then choose **Restart Audio Engine**. Then restart the app with no sound (Discord, OBS) - not the whole PC.

Hearing your own voice in your headphones? That is mic A1 switched ON by mistake. Turn mic A1 OFF, keep mic B1 ON (Step 6).

CHECK: Sound is back. Write down which number fixed it - that is your number next time too.

CUT OUT AND KEEP BY THE COMPUTER

Quick reference card

If you want...	Do this
Hear anything at all	Potato open + **A1** = your headphones (Step 3)
Be heard on a call	Mic = Input 1, **B1 ON, A1 OFF** (Steps 4 + 6)
Hear a video / game	VAIO strip, **A1 ON** (Step 6)
Share video sound on a call	VAIO strip, add **B1 ON** (Step 6)
Windows default	Playback: **Voicemeeter Input (VAIO)** Recording: **Voicemeeter Output (VAIO)**
App mic (Discord/Zoom/OBS)	**Voicemeeter Output** = microphone **Voicemeeter Aux Input** = speaker
Can't see Voicemeeter Output?	Look for **Voicemeeter Out B1** - same thing, newer name
No sound	Potato open? A1 picked? A1 lit? Restart Audio Engine

A

A = Actual ears - for you

B

B = Broadcast - for them

Version 3 - checked against the official manual. This handout has been error-checked against the official VoiceMeeter Potato User Manual (Voicemeeter 3.1.3.0, VB-Audio Software, vb-audio.com; ZIP package Voicemeeter8Setup_v3130.zip, 72.2 MB; install as administrator and reboot). Four fixes came from that check: (1) the newer name **Voicemeeter Out B1** means the same as Voicemeeter Output; (2) Step 3 now adds **Run at Startup**, so Potato opens by itself after every restart; (3) Step 5 now sets the **Communications** tab to **Do nothing**, so calls do not turn your sound down; (4) Step 3 now mentions **ASIO** as well as WDM for A1. Button pictures in this version: the A1 to A5 buttons, the strip A1 and B1 buttons, the Menu button, and the Windows Sound box with its Set Default and OK buttons are tight crops cut out of real screenshots, so they match what you see on screen. The download and install pictures (Steps 1 and 2) are still labelled diagrams, and a live run-through on a real Windows PC is still to come. **Part 2** pictures are real Windows 10 screenshots of Potato 3.1.3.0, except four labelled manual figures.

You did it. Potato is installed, Windows obeys it, your voice goes to B1 and your ears live on A1. That is a working setup - stamp it GrandMa Proof.